



Dig Deeper

Thinking through hard questions

1. The people in William's church in England were more interested in repairing their church than listening to William's heart for sharing the gospel. Why do you think that was? Could they have supported William without going with him? How does your church listen to foreign missionaries?
2. William Carey describes the mission field as a great harvest, using the analogy of pruning and being pruned before seeing fruit to describe mission work throughout the story. How is God pruning your life so that fruit can be born?
3. The custom of burning widows in India upset William Carey for many reasons. Why did the Indian people participate in this tradition? What was William's primary argument against it? What was "the other way" William wanted the people of India to know about?
4. What is the caste system that William Carey encountered in India? What do think the Bible has to say about social classes in any culture?
5. The story ends with a quote by William Carey that says "I am not afraid of failure. I am afraid of succeeding in things that don't matter." How does this inform your dreams for the future? What should Christians be seeking after?



Christianity vs. Hinduism

Do you know the differences between these two major world religions?

Put the number of each statement under Christianity or Hinduism,
and then check your answers below!

1. Worldview: the universe and everything in it IS god and belongs to god. Additionally, everyone is divine, and the purpose of life is to cleanse ourselves to reach our true divinity

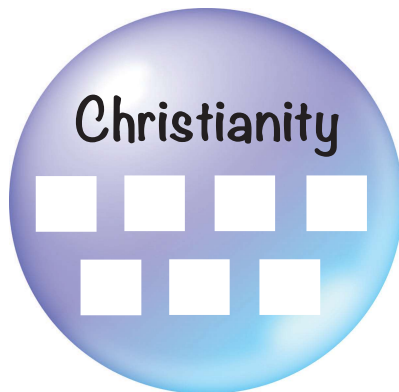
2. One trinitarian God: Father, Son and Holy Spirit

3. 2.5 billion followers worldwide

4. Native religion of India

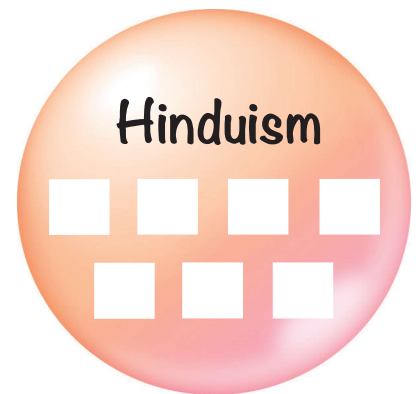
5. Founded by Jesus and his Apostles in AD 30 in Israel

6. Afterlife: reincarnation after death until enlightenment



7. Spiritual disciplines: yoga, meditation, worship (puja), pilgrimage, dharma (living according to one's purpose)

8. Holy Texts: Bible



10. Holy Texts: the Vedas

9. 900 million followers worldwide

11. Worldview: all have sinned and fallen short of the Glory of God. Salvation from death (sin) comes from faith in Jesus, God's Son.

12. Spiritual disciplines: prayer, worship, church, sacraments (baptism, communion)

13. One supreme reality (Brahma) manifested in many gods and goddesses

14. Afterlife: heaven for the believers covered by Jesus' sacrifice, hell for non-believers

Answers:
Christianity: 2, 3, 5, 8, 11, 12, 14
Hinduism: 1, 4, 6, 7, 9, 10, 13